GALAXUS

Controls. Press F1 in flight for this list on screen. Pitch follows a flight stick: pull back (or press Down) to raise the nose. Both can be inverted in Settings.

FLYING

Action	Keyboard and mouse	Gamepad
Pitch and yaw	Mouse, ↑ ↓ ← →	Left stick
Yaw	A D	Left stick
Roll	Q E	Bumpers, right stick sideways
Throttle up and down	W S	Right stick up and down
Zero throttle	X	Right stick click
Thrusters up, down, left, right	R F Z C	
Flight assist on or off	G	B
Chase or cockpit camera	V	Y

IN A FIGHT

Power pips. Six pips are shared between engines, shields and weapons. Pressing a system's key moves a pip to it, taking half from each of the others.

Lead indicator. The red diamond near your target shows where to aim so your shots arrive where it will be.

Aim assist. When your target's lead point is within a few degrees of the nose, your guns swing to it.

Missiles. Keep your target near the nose and a ring closes in on it; when it turns solid red and reads LOCKED, fire. Fighters carry six, restocked when you dock. When one is coming for you, turn hard across its path.

Difficulty. Easy, Normal or Hard, in Settings: how much damage you take and how good enemy pilots are. Practise in the dogfight simulator, under New game.

FIGHTING AND POWER

Action	Keyboard and mouse	Gamepad
Fire	Space, left click	Right trigger
Fire a missile (once locked)	B, right click	Left trigger
Next target	T	A
Match target speed	Tab	
Power to engines	1	D-pad up
Power to shields	2	D-pad left
Power to weapons	3	D-pad right
Balance power	4	D-pad down

STATIONS, MAP AND MENUS

Action	Keyboard and mouse	Gamepad
Dock (close and slow) or undock	Enter	X
Galaxy map	M	Start
System map: set a course	N	View / Share
Cruise drive on and off	J	Left stick click
System map: find your ship	C	
Speed time up, slow it down	. ,	
Follow your next job	L	
Performance readout	F3	
Map: zoom and pan	Scroll wheel, right-drag	
Pause menu: save, load, settings	Esc	
Controls on screen	F1	
Quit	F10	

HOW IT HANDLES

Flight assist on holds the speed you set with the throttle and keeps the ship travelling where the nose points. **Off**, the drives just push and you drift until you counter-thrust.

Turn tightest at lower speed. Your pilot can only take so much g, so turn rate falls as speed rises. The HUD shows the best turning speed.

Mouse flying. The mouse moves a dot inside a ring at the centre of the screen. The further the dot from the centre, the harder you turn. Bring it back to fly straight.

Collisions. The station is solid: bump it gently and you bounce off, ram it and you take damage. Cruise drops you out before you reach a planet or star. Fly into one and you lose the ship.

Landing. Set a course to a surface port (amber on the system map) and cruise in. Fly down to the pad, come in below 25 m/s and press Enter. Touch down gently anywhere else and you land; come down fast and you crash.

Docking. Fly within 500 m of the station below 80 m/s, then press Enter. The game saves automatically each time you dock.

Getting around a system. Open the system map, click a planet, station or port and set a course, then press J. With a course set, cruise is an autopilot: it turns you to the target, builds speed once you're lined up, and drops you out beside it. Push the stick or mouse well over to take control; let go and it takes over again. Without a course, J is a fast drive that goes where you point.

Time. Speed time up to 20 times for long cruises and descents. It drops back to normal by itself in a fight, near a dock, low over the ground, or when you drop out of cruise.

Gravity. Worlds pull according to their mass. Flight assist holds you up like any other drift; turn it off and you fall.

Jobs. The job you're following shows top right with your next step. Its system is ringed and routed on the galaxy map, and its station is marked on the system map. Deliver by docking at the named station or port. L switches job; the galaxy map lists them all.

Travel. Pick a system on the map and jump. Days pass on the way, the galaxy moves on, and jobs for that system pay out on arrival. Gate systems are linked by routes. Zoom right in to see the stars between them: any star inside the green ring is in range of your jump drive.